Firsts & Records

> **Priority B** | About **5%** of Current Affairs Whenever news says **first**, **largest**, or **only**, slow down. These lines become questions.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What exactly is first?	The claim
Who / where?	Person, city, country
What second fact comes with it?	Examiners often make the second line false

January 2026

First big national showcase of LR-AShM

What happened At Republic Day 2026, DRDO publicly showcased the **Long Range Anti-Ship Hypersonic Missile (LR-AShM)** as a major indigenous hypersonic anti-ship system.

How to remember it safely

- Safe fact: first major national parade showcase of this **anti-ship hypersonic** system in this form.
- Unsafe over-claim: “India’s first hypersonic test ever”.
- Full technical card → Science / Space / Defence.

India–EU FTA called India’s largest

What happened On **27 January 2026**, India and the EU announced that FTA negotiations were concluded. Official messaging called it India’s largest FTA with a major partner market.

Trap

- Negotiations concluded ≠ treaty already in force.

February 2026

Firsts from February

- The **India–AI Impact Summit** was described as the first major global AI summit of this scale in the **Global South**.
- Union Budget 2026–27 was the first Budget prepared in **Kartavya Bhawan**.
- Budget proposed **NIMHANS-2** in **North India**.
- **Rouble Nagi** became the Indian winner of the Global Teacher Prize 2026.
- UP notes: CCSU Meerut as a national AI-university pilot; Greater Noida semiconductor “North India’s first” claim (status-sensitive).

March 2026

Firsts from sports and policy

- India became the **first** team to **defend** the Men’s T20 World Cup title.
- India became the **first host** country to win the Men’s T20 World Cup.
- India became the **first** team to win the Men’s T20 World Cup **three times**.
- Gujarat became the **second** Indian state to pass a full UCC law after Uttarakhand.
- NavIC fell below the minimum **four** positioning satellites after the IRNSS-1F clock failure.

April 2026

Firsts to fact

- Census 2027 is India's **first** mainly **digital** Census with online **self-enumeration**.
- **PFBR** at Kalpakkam attained **first criticality** (start of controlled fission) on **6 April 2026**.
- **NASM-SR** maiden **salvo** launch from a helicopter (two missiles from the same platform).
- **NASM-SR** is India's **first indigenous air-launched anti-ship missile**.
- **INS Aridhaman** is India's **third** indigenous SSBN.
- **INS Taragiri** is the **fourth** Project 17A / Nilgiri-class frigate commissioned.
- **Kankaria Coaching Depot** (Ahmedabad) was covered as India's **first water-neutral** railway depot.
- **Ashwini Bhide** was covered as the **first woman** BMC Commissioner.
- **Susan Coyle** was covered as Australia's **first female Army Chief**.
- Ladakh expanded from **2** to **7** districts.
- Shekha Jheel took India to **99** Ramsar sites (one short of 100).

May 2026

Firsts to fact

- **Sikkim** covered as India's **first paperless judiciary** state.
- Squadron Leader **Saanya** covered as the IAF's **first woman Cat-A** flying instructor.
- **South Coast Railway Zone** created; total railway zones become **19**.
- Supreme Court sanctioned strength rises to **38** including the CJI (**37** + CJI).
- **Saudi Arabia** becomes the **26th** IBCA member and first Arab member in coverage.
- **Taiwan Travelogue** is the first Taiwanese Mandarin / Mandarin-Chinese translated novel to win the International Booker in coverage.
- **RCB** becomes only the **third** IPL side to win back-to-back titles (after CSK and MI).
- Santa Marta hosted the **first** international conference on transitioning away from fossil fuels.

June 2026

Firsts to fact

- India reaches **100** Ramsar sites with **Surha Tal** (Ballia).
- UP reaches **13** Ramsar sites.
- **Noida International Airport (Jewar)** begins commercial flights (**15 June**).
- Coverage of India's **first offshore airport** approval off **Palghar**, Maharashtra.
- Coast Guard inducts first indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle **H-561**.
- Supreme Court elevates walking on a demarcated footpath as a fundamental-right priority.
- **Sudarsan Pattnaik** covered as first Indian to win Russia's Grand Sand Master Cup.
- VB-G RAM G raises rural job guarantee from **100** to **125** days (from 1 July).

July 2026

Firsts to fact

- **VB-G RAM G** replaces MGNREGA framework with a **125-day** guarantee.
- **Skyroot Vikram-1** — India's first privately developed **orbital-class** rocket (Mission Aagaman).
- **Kusha** — maiden flight of indigenous long-range SAM / XRSAM line.
- **INS Mahendragiri** — sixth Project 17A frigate.
- India–UK **CETA** and **DCC** both enter force on **15 July 2026**.

- Direct commercial container freight train India → Nepal (**Biratnagar**) in coverage.
- **Spain** wins FIFA World Cup for the second time (after 2010); first nation to hold men's and women's FIFA World Cups at once in coverage.
- **Australia** wins Women's T20 World Cup; **Ellyse Perry** unique multi-trophy feat.
- **PV Sindhu** — first Indian to win the Japan Open badminton title in coverage.
- Commonwealth Games: **Gabon** and **Togo** debut.

August 2026

Firsts to fact

- First Red Fort I-Day programme performance of **Vande Mataram** by the Army band.
- **Glaw Lake** — Arunachal's **first** Ramsar site; India's **101st**.
- **Sher** — first fully indigenous (**100%** Indian parts) AK-203 rifle from Amethi.
- **3rd National Space Day** (23 August).
- India finishes **4th** at Commonwealth Games Glasgow with **39** medals.
- **R. Praggnanandhaa** — first Indian to win the **Grand Chess Tour** in coverage.
- **Kaziah Liz Mejo** — first Kerala Miss Universe India winner in about 64 years (coverage).
- Made-in-India **C-295** defence transport aircraft flight success highlighted in I-Day speech.

Other Notable National & State Firsts (Eye Drishti 2026)

- **First Indian State to Conduct Mobile Phone e-Voting**: Bihar (municipal bypolls on 28 June 2025 across 6 urban local bodies).
- **India's Largest Battery-Based Solar Plant**: Operationalized at **Kajra (Lakhisarai district, Bihar)** — 301 MW solar generation paired with a 495 MWh Battery Energy Storage System (BESS).
- **India's First AI-Based Cyber Helpline Call Centre**: Automated triage and complaint registration launched for helpline **1930** in Bihar.
- **Third NIFTEM in India**: Sanctioned at **Hajipur (Vaishali, Bihar)** across 100 acres (after Kundli, Haryana and Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu).
- **India's First Gold in World Para Athletics High Jump T63**: Won by **Shailesh Kumar** with an Asian & Championship record clearance of **1.91 metres**.
- **First Leader from the BJP to become Bihar Chief Minister**: **Samrat Choudhary** (sworn in as 24th CM on 15 April 2026).

October 2026

High-Yield Firsts & Records (October 2026)

- **First-Ever Mid-Air Booster Catch in Aerospace History:** On **13 October 2026**, SpaceX's **Starship Flight 5** successfully recovered its 71-metre-tall Super Heavy rocket booster mid-air using the dual mechanical arms ("chopsticks") of the Mechazilla launch tower at Starbase in Boca Chica, Texas.
- **First Time 5 Languages Granted Classical Status Simultaneously:** The Union Cabinet approved Classical Language status for **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali** together on **3 October 2026**, bringing India's total from 6 to **11**.
- **First Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir: Omar Abdullah** was sworn in on **16 October 2026** as the first CM of the UT following the 2019 reorganisation.
- **First South Korean Nobel Laureate in Literature:** Novelist **Han Kang** (*The Vegetarian*, *Human Acts*) became the first South Korean writer and the first Asian woman to win the Nobel Prize in Literature.
- **First Maiden ICC Women's T20 World Cup for New Zealand:** New Zealand defeated South Africa by 32 runs in Dubai on **20 October 2026** to claim their first-ever women's T20 World Cup title.
- **Dual Guinness World Records at Ayodhya Deepotsav:** 1. Record **26,17,215 (over 26.17 lakh) earthen diyas** illuminated across 56 ghats along the Saryu River. 2. Record **2,128 priests** performing a simultaneous, synchronized Saryu Maha Aarti.
- **First Indian EAM Visit to Pakistan in 9 Years:** External Affairs Minister **Dr. S. Jaishankar** travelled to Islamabad for the 23rd SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting (15–16 October 2026), the first visit by an Indian EAM since December 2015.

- **India's 2nd Naval VLF Transmission Station:** Foundation stone laid at **Damagundam Forest, Vikarabad (Telangana)** for submarine communication (second to **INS Kattabomman**, Tirunelveli, TN).

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sikkim was covered as the first paperless judiciary state in May 2026 coverage.
2. Vikram-1 (Mission Aagaman) was reported as the first privately developed Indian orbital-class rocket.
3. India's first offshore airport approval path in coverage was off Palghar, Maharashtra.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Mixed "which is correct" on firsts — paperless judiciary / offshore airport / private rocket. **Ans: D.** All three are "first / record" facts — UPPCS loves the second detail, so revise place names carefully.

Q2. With reference to India's Men's T20 World Cup win (March 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India became the first team to defend the Men's T20 World Cup title.
2. India became the first host country to win the Men's T20 World Cup.
3. Gujarat became the first Indian state to implement a Uniform Civil Code.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: T20 WC "first" claims — defend / host / three titles. **Ans: A.** (3) false — Gujarat is **second** after Uttarakhand. Classic "first" second-sentence trap mixed into a sports firsts stem.

Q3. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Census 2027 is covered as India's first mainly digital Census with self-enumeration.
2. PFBR Kalpakkam attained first criticality on 6 April 2026.
3. NASM-SR is covered as India's first indigenous air-launched anti-ship missile.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Digital Census + PFBR first criticality + NASM-SR first indigenous air-launched AShM. **Ans: D.** All three are April "first" facts. Trap: writing thorium as the first-criticality fuel (that belongs under Science).

Q4. With reference to February 2026 "firsts", which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The India–AI Impact Summit was described as the first major global AI summit of this scale in the Global South.
2. Union Budget 2026–27 was the first Budget prepared in Kartavya Bhawan.
3. The India–EU FTA entered into force on 27 January 2026 as India's largest FTA.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: AI Summit Global South first + Kartavya Bhawan Budget first. **Ans: A.** (3) false — negotiations concluded ≠ already in force. Firsts sheet must keep the second-fact trap.

Q5. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Surha Tal took India to 100 Ramsar sites.
2. Glaw Lake is Arunachal's first Ramsar site.
3. AK-203 'Sher' was covered as the first fully indigenous (100% Indian parts) rifle from the Amethi plant.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Surha Tal 100 / Glaw first Arunachal / Sher 100% indigenous. **Ans: D.** June–August firsts cluster. Trap: putting Glaw Lake in UP.

Q6. Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Ashwini Bhide — first woman BMC Commissioner
2. Susan Coyle — Australia's first female Army Chief
3. Squadron Leader Saanya — IAF's first woman Cat-A flying instructor (coverage)

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ashwini Bhide / Susan Coyle / Saanya woman firsts. **Ans: D.** Personality–first hybrids. Trap: swapping BMC with a municipal body in another city.

Q7. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. RCB became only the third IPL side to win back-to-back titles (after CSK and MI) in coverage.
2. Spain was covered as the first nation holding men's and women's FIFA World Cups at once after the 2026 men's win.
3. R. Praggnanandhaa was covered as the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: RCB back-to-back third franchise; Spain dual FIFA fact; Pragg Grand Chess Tour. **Ans: D.** Sports firsts. Trap: writing MI as the 2026 IPL winner.

Q8. With reference to Independence Day 2026 culture firsts, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Coverage locked the first Red Fort I-Day programme performance of Vande Mataram by the Army band.
2. National Space Day 2026 was observed on 15 August.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Vande Mataram Army band first at Red Fort I-Day. **Ans: D.** Space Day is **23 August**. Trap: merging I-Day and Space Day.

Q9. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Republic Day 2026 was a major national showcase of LR-AShM.
2. Safe fact is first major parade showcase of this anti-ship hypersonic form — not 'India's first hypersonic test ever'.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: LR-AShM parade showcase careful claim. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Census 2027 is India's first mainly digital Census with self-enumeration.
2. Phase 1 began around 1 April 2026.
3. Phase 1 completed the full caste census in April 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Census first digital. **Ans: A.** Phase 2 people/caste.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Taiwan Travelogue was covered as first Taiwanese Mandarin translated novel to win International Booker.
2. Author Yáng Shuāng-zǐ; translator Lin King.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Taiwan Travelogue Booker first Taiwanese Mandarin. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Saudi Arabia was first Arab IBCA member in coverage.
2. It was the 26th IBCA member.
3. It founded IBCA in 2015 as sole member.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Saudi first Arab IBCA. **Ans: A.** (3) false.

Q13. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Surha Tal took India to 100 Ramsar sites.
2. Glaw Lake took India to 101.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: 100 Ramsar milestone. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Vikram-1 is first privately developed Indian orbital-class rocket.
2. Mission name Aagaman.
3. It is an ISRO GSLV Mk III only.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Vikram-1 private orbital first. **Ans: A.** Private Skyroot.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sikkim covered as first paperless judiciary state.
2. Linked with Gangtok conclave / CJI Surya Kant in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Paperless judiciary Sikkim. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India's first offshore airport approval path off Palghar, Maharashtra.
2. It is the same as Jewar Airport.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Palghar offshore airport first path. **Ans: D.** Different projects.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Spain's 2026 men's title was its second after 2010.
2. Coverage locked Spain as first to hold men's and women's FIFA World Cups at once.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Spain second FIFA + dual men's women's fact. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q18. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Gabon and Togo debuted at CWG Glasgow.
2. Mascot Finnie.
3. Mascot Morveer.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Gabon Togo CWG debut. **Ans: A.** Morveer = Tribal Games.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Kaziah Liz Mejo covered as first Kerala Miss Universe India winner in about 64 years.
2. Crowned in Jaipur.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Kaziah Kerala Miss Universe India first in ~64 years. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Made-in-India C-295 defence transport aircraft success highlighted in I-Day speech coverage.
2. It replaces all commercial airliners in India.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: C-295 Made-in-India I-Day highlight. **Ans: D.** Defence transport fact.